



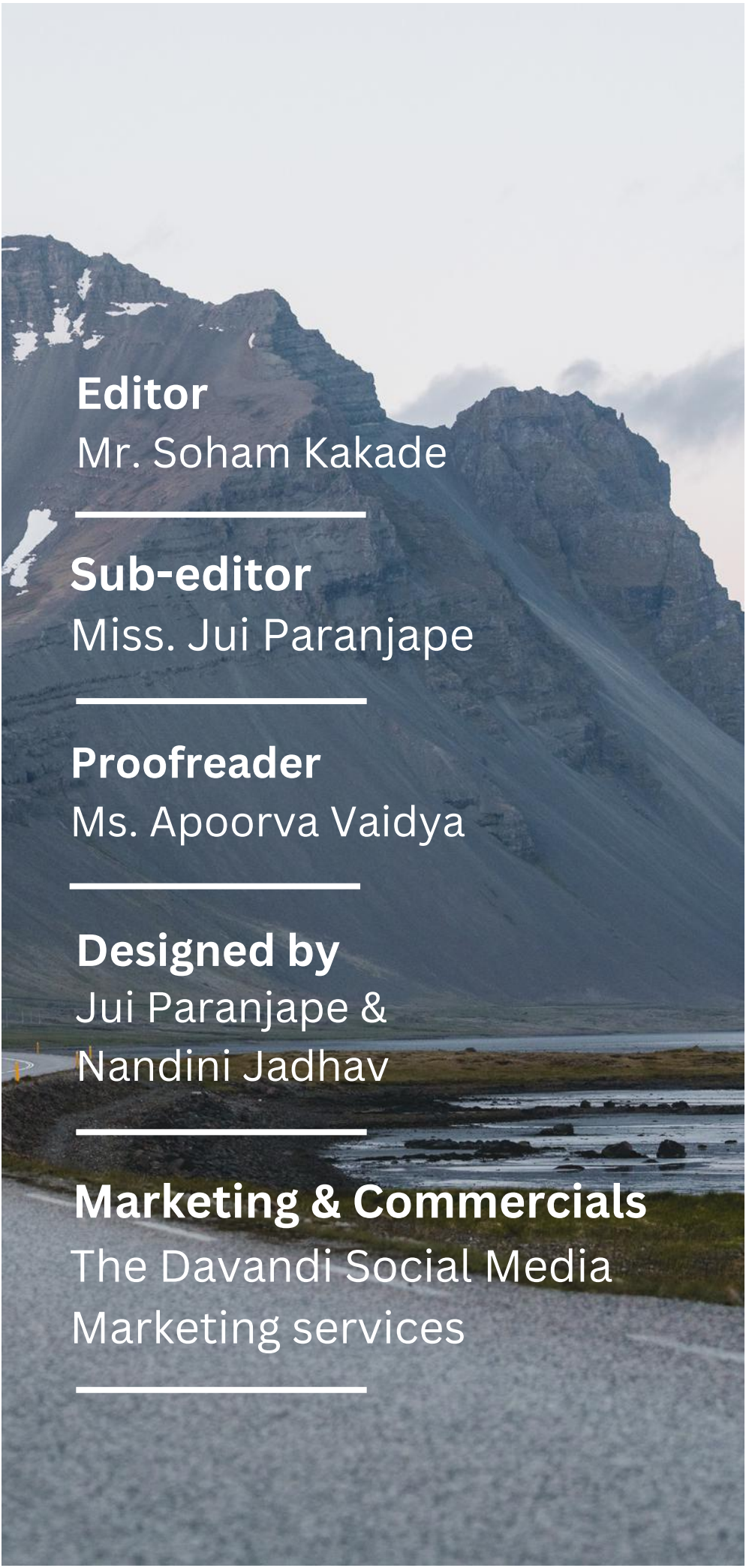
THE LANGUAGE GAZETTE

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DISCOVER

"When Language Barriers Turn Travel into an Adventure"

MEET THE TEAM



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Dr. Rajshree Tamhane*



EDITORIAL

Terminal 2017

HOW I ACCIDENTALLY BECAME AN INTERPRETER AT BEIJING AIRPORT DURING THE DOKLAM CRISIS



During the peak of the India-China tension over Doklam, I landed straight into one of the craziest experiences of my life. I got stuck at Beijing Airport along with about 200 other Indians – and guess what? Hardly any of them could speak a word of Chinese. Not even a simple "Ni hao."

Luckily (or unluckily, depending on how you see it), I could speak Chinese. And the moment people realized it, all hell broke loose. Suddenly, I became everyone's go-to guy. "Bhaiya yeh bol do..." "Madam please tell them..." "Bhai toothbrush chahiye..." "Pura roti aur paneer ki sabzi mil sakti hai kya?"

Every 2 minutes someone would tap my shoulder with a new mission.

The situation wasn't just annoying — it was a full-on mess. Our flight wasn't delayed by a couple of hours, it was delayed by 64 freaking hours. No proper explanation. No clarity whether this was because of the political tension, or just some big technical drama. Half of us thought we were lowkey being held hostage, while the other half was just too tired and hungry to care.

So there I was, stuck between a panicking Indian crowd and confused Chinese airport officials. And somehow, I became the unofficial translator, coordinator, negotiator, and sometimes even a punching bag.

From asking for food (which obviously wasn't roti-paneer) to getting people hotel rooms, to calming down passengers who were screaming bloody murder — I did everything. I talked to the staff, argued with the airline, requested basic necessities, explained flight status updates — the whole circus.

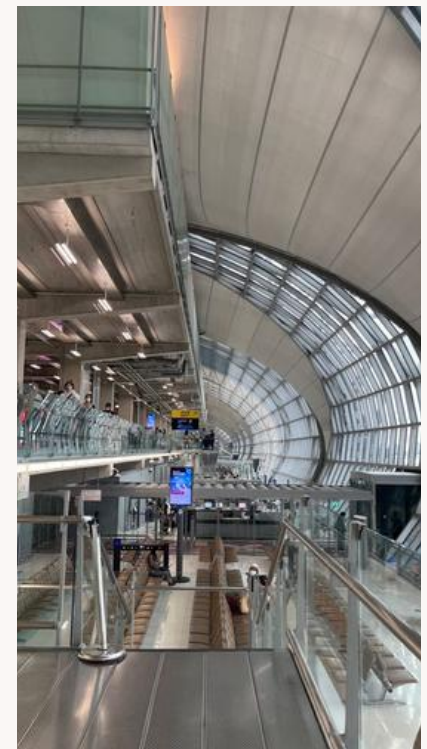
Honestly, it wasn't easy. The Chinese airport staff were already stressed out because they didn't expect to handle 200 frustrated Indians with no Chinese skills. I had to simplify everything — breaking complicated complaints into simple Chinese, using gestures, sometimes even drawing rough sketches to explain things faster. It was pure survival mode. Looking back, those crazy 64 hours actually taught me more about simultaneous interpreting than any formal course could have.

No fancy theory. No perfect words. Just pure, real-time communication under extreme pressure.

By the second day, even the Chinese officials started calling me whenever they needed something translated quickly. Somehow, I had earned their trust too. I wasn't just helping my fellow Indians — I was helping the staff manage the situation without it turning into a full-on diplomatic disaster.

That airport nightmare honestly shaped a big part of my career. Today when people ask me how I got into interpreting, I just laugh and say, "It all started when I was helping people find toothbrushes and demand paneer sabzi at Beijing Airport."

Toughest 64 hours of my life. But also the most unforgettable.



Mr. Soham Kakade
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My time at EWAN was an incredibly valuable journey that taught me a great deal about the corporate world and the language services industry. I gained firsthand experience in how businesses operate and how language services play a crucial role in sectors like healthcare, technology, and finance by enabling global communication.

When I started, I had limited knowledge of business operations, but over time, I developed a deep appreciation for how language services help companies overcome communication barriers and expand into new markets. I learned how vital translation, interpretation, and localization are for businesses to connect with international clients while maintaining accuracy and cultural relevance.

Additionally, I developed essential business skills, including proficiency in Outlook and other tools, with the support of my colleagues. This journey not only enhanced my technical skills but also contributed to my personal growth, leaving me more confident in pursuing future opportunities.

My experience with EWAN's branding archetype development was one of the most transformative aspects of my time there. I had the opportunity to contribute to the company's branding, which was both exciting and insightful. What made the work particularly interesting was the focus on archetypes, each of which comes with its own unique color palette. I learned how to select the right archetype and choose colors that best represented the company's identity—ensuring they were not only suitable but also visually striking and easily recognizable. Throughout the process, I collaborated closely with the team, who provided invaluable support and guidance. This allowed me to explore different brand personas and understand how these could shape the company's market presence and client engagement strategies. It was truly a rewarding experience that gave me great insight into the world of branding.

I am grateful for my time at EWAN and the guidance I received from my mentors and colleagues, which made this experience so enriching and rewarding.

Mr. Amey Dixit
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A BACKPACKER WHO TRAVELLED IN A FERRARI

En Junio de 2018, estaba viajando desde Girona a Empuriabrava en Cataluña. El viaje anterior, de Barcelona a Girona a Empuriabrava, pasó muy bien, cogí el autobús tan pronto que bajé del tren en Girona. Resulta que mi colega que viajaba conmigo quería hacer paracaidismo y Empuriabrava era su lugar preferido. Desafortunadamente había mal tiempo y no pudo hacer nada. Durante el viaje de vuelta nos dimos cuenta de que Empuriabrava sólo tenía el autobús como la única manera de viajar hasta Girona. El autobús que viene cada hora, es pequeñito y para fuera de la ciudad en la carretera. ue las 3 de la tarde y estábamos en la parada de autobús en la carretera.

Mi colega me sugirió pedir a alguien. Me dijo que eso pudiera ser un momento especial de la vida. Yo le dije que tal vez pudiera ser el último momento de nuestra vida. Pero no me escuchó, se adelantó y pidió un lift a una persona. YO NO QUERÍA IR, en ninguna circunstancia. Pero ella subió y me dijo que ella iba a ir, yo o puedo acompañarle o lo que sea. Con mucha ansia subí, pero me quedé de piedra cuando me di cuenta que era un Ferrari Convertible. El señor que nos llevó condujo con la velocidad de casi 120-130 kmph. El viaje era de casi 50 kilómetros que terminó en 20 minutos. Era una experiencia inolvidable





In June 2018, I was traveling from Girona to Empuriabrava in Catalonia. The previous trip, from Barcelona to Girona to Empuriabrava, went very well. I took the bus as soon as I got off the train in Girona. It turns out that my colleague, who was traveling with me, wanted to go skydiving, and Empuriabrava was her favorite spot. Unfortunately, the weather was bad, and she couldn't do anything. During the return trip, we realized that Empuriabrava only had a bus as the only way to travel to Girona. The bus, which comes every hour, is tiny, and stops outside the city on the highway. It was 3 p.m. and we were at the bus stop on the highway. My colleague suggested I ask someone. She told me that this could be a special moment in my life. I told her it could be the last moment of our lives. But she didn't listen; she went ahead and asked for a lift to someone. I DID NOT WANT TO GO, under any circumstances. But she got in and told me she was going, and I could go with her or whatever. I got in anxiously, but I was shocked when I realized it was a Ferrari Convertible. The man who drove us drove at a speed of almost 120-130 km/h. The trip was almost 50 kilometers and took 20 minutes to complete. It was an unforgettable experience.

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말은 달라도 마음은 통해요: 언어와 여행이 가르쳐준 인 연의 힘

인도에는 이런 말이 있어요, “Har 10 km, bhasha badalti hai” (10킬로미터마다 언어가 바뀐다)이 말, 저는 정말 뱉속 깊이 느껴봤습니다.

저는 인도 우타르프라데시(UP) 서부에 있는 라키푸르 케리라는 작은 도시에서 자랐어요. 그곳의 지역 언어인 아와디(Awadhi)는 리듬감도 있고, 따뜻하고, 유쾌한 풍자까지 담겨 있어요. 그런데 같은 UP 안에서도 몇 개 구역만 옮겨도, 똑같은 문장이 갑자기 수수께끼처럼 들립니다. 이 “언어 변화”를 진짜 체감한 건, 델리로 유학을 갔을 때였어요.

델리는 그냥 도시가 아니라, 인도 전역에서 온 사람들이 섞여 사는 진짜 ‘언어의 용광로’거든요. 각자 다른 억양, 단어, 표현을 가방에 넣어 가지고 온 셈이죠.

저는 자와할랄 네루 대학교(JNU)에서 5년 통합 한국어 과정을 밟게 되었어요. 캠퍼스 자체가 작은 UP 같았어요. 인도는 물론, 전 세계에서 온 사람들이 어깨를 맞대고 걸어 다녔죠. 처음엔 고향에서 배운 nawabi 스타일의 표현을 슬쩍 썼죠. 그런데 곧 깨달았어요—제가 moongfali라고 부르는 땅콩을 누군가는 badaam이라고 부르는 거예요! 이 작은 땅콩이 구내식당에서 엄청난 논쟁을 불러일으켜 쓰죠.

어느 날은 차를 사고 나서 아무 생각 없이 “shukriya”라고 말했더니, 차 파는 형이 멈칫하더니 이렇게 말했어요: “Aap Urdu wale ho kya?” 그때 깨달았어요. 말은 단순한 도구가 아니라 정체성이구나. 같은 나라 안에서도 사용하는 단어 하나로, 내가 ‘익숙한 사람’이 될 수도, ‘이방인’이 될 수도 있구나.





할머니는 제 ‘살아 있는 사전’이자, 내가 어디서 왔는지를 일깨워주는 나침반이에요. 물론, 언어 장벽은 인도 안에서만 존재하는 게 아니었어요. 한국어를 배우고 한국 사람들과 대화하면서, 전혀 새로운 오해와 깨달음의 세계가 열렸죠.

한번은 한국 식당에서 자신만만하게 “비빔밥 주세요!”라고 했는데, 억양이 이상했는지 완전 다른 매운 음식이 나왔어요. 아직도 그 요리 이름을 몰라요. 근데... 맛있었어요. 그날 저녁이 그렇게 정해졌고, 지금은 웃으며 얘기할 수 있는 추억이 됐죠.

이제는 확실히 알게 됐어요. 언어는 단순한 문법이나 단어가 아니에요. 그건 감정이고, 정체성이며, 그리고 무엇보다 연결이에요. 말이 안 통해도, 미소 하나, 손짓 하나, 같이 나누는 밥 한 끼가 생각보다 더 큰 다리가 될 수 있어요.

언어 때문에 길을 잃어도, 진심 덕분에 인연을 만날 수 있어요. 여행을 하고, 언어를 배우고, 도시를 옮겨다니며 제가 진짜 배운 건 이거예요: 언어는 장벽이 아니에요. 다리예요. 그리고 가끔은, 그 ‘틀린 말 한마디’가 가장 멋진 모험의 시작이 되기도 합니다.



Lost in Translation, Found in Connection: My Journey Through Language and Travel

There is an old saying in India, “Har 10 km, bhasha badalti hai”, every 10 kilometers, the language changes. And trust me, I have felt this in my bones. I come from a small town in western Uttar Pradesh called Lakhimpur-Kheri, where the local tongue, Awadhi, carries a rhythm, warmth and satire of its own. But even within UP, move a few districts, and suddenly the same sentence sounds like a riddle.

My first real experience of this “language shift” came when I moved to Delhi for higher studies. Delhi is not just a city, it is a melting pot of people from across India, each bringing their own dialect, accent, and vocabulary. I was excited and nervous as I stepped into Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU), where I enrolled in a five-year integrated course in Korean Language. The campus itself felt like a mini-UP.

People from all corners of India, and the world walked those paths, carrying with them not just bags, but entire word banks of their own.

Initially, I found comfort in slipping in a few “nawabi” phrases—things I picked up back home. But soon I realized, what I called moongfali (peanuts), someone else was calling badaam. A harmless peanut sparked passionate debates in the canteen! Once, after buying chai, I



casually said shukriya to the chai wale bhaiya. He paused, looked at me with a confused smile, and replied, “Aap Urdu wale ho kya?” That is when I understood, words carry identity. The language we use can make us familiar or foreign, even within our own country.

One of my most cherished connections is with my grandmother. She is the only person I speak to in pure Awadhi. Her phrases, her expressions, they are not just words, they are poetry. She says things like “ghar mein jo na bole, bahar kya bolenge” (If you can’t speak your language at home, what will you say outside?). Whenever I feel my grip on Awadhi slipping, I talk to her. She is my dictionary, my reminder of where I come from.

Language barriers did not just appear in India, though. Studying Korean and interacting with native speakers opened a whole new world of misunderstandings and learning.



I once confidently asked for “bibimbab” in a Korean restaurant, but I must have messed up the tone because they brought me something completely different, some spicy dish I still do not know the name of. But guess what? It was delicious. And that became my dinner, and a story I now laugh about.



Language is not just grammar and words, it is emotion, identity, and connection. I have learned that even if you do not speak the same tongue, a smile, a gesture, or even a shared meal can do wonders. You may be lost in translation, but you can still be found in connection.

Traveling, studying languages, or simply moving cities, all of it has taught me that language is never a barrier. It is a bridge. And sometimes, the best adventures begin when you forget the right word and say something entirely wrong.

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QUAND LES BARRIÈRES LINGUISTIQUES TRANSFORMENT UN VOYAGE EN AVENTURE



Je ris encore en repensant au jour où je me suis complètement perdu dans une ville étrangère. Pas d'internet, pas de moyen de traduire, juste moi tenant une carte froissée comme si elle allait soudainement parler français. J'ai arrêté un homme qui vendait des marrons grillés, j'ai pointé ma carte et massacré ce que je *croyais* être le mot local pour "où". Il m'a regardé, puis la carte, puis encore moi. Et soudain, il a commencé à marcher. Pas d'explication, pas de mots. Juste un petit geste de la main pour me faire signe de le suivre.

À ce stade, avais-je vraiment le choix ? J'ai suivi.

On a marché une dizaine de minutes, zigzaguant dans des ruelles que je n'aurais jamais trouvées seul. À un moment, il s'est arrêté pour acheter un journal et m'a tendu un marron, comme pour dire *détends-toi, tu vas y arriver*. Finalement, il a pointé un immeuble—mon hôtel. Je me suis tourné pour le remercier, mais il était déjà reparti, comme si de rien n'était.

Voyager sans parler la langue peut sembler compliqué, mais c'est ce qui crée les meilleures histoires. Comme cette fois où j'ai voulu commander du thé et ai accidentellement demandé *ta grand-mère*. Ou quand une vieille dame au marché a décidé que j'avais besoin d'une écharpe et me l'a mise autour du cou, souriant comme si elle avait changé ma vie.

Ou encore ce taxi où, avec mon seul mot appris, je me suis retrouvé à un mariage. J'ai mangé, j'ai dansé et je suis reparti avec des amis qui ne parlaient pas un mot de ma langue. Les mots importent peu. Les gens trouvent toujours un moyen de se comprendre. Et ce sont ces moments-là qu'on n'oublie jamais.



WHEN LANGUAGE BARRIERS TURN TRAVEL INTO ADVENTURE

I still laugh when I think about the time I got hopelessly lost in a foreign city. No internet, no way to translate, just me holding a crumpled map like it was going to magically start speaking English. I stopped a man selling roasted chestnuts, pointed at my map, and butchered what I *thought* was the local word for "where."

He squinted at me, then at the map, then back at me. And then—he just started walking. No explanation, no words. Just a quick wave for me to follow.

At that point, what choice did I have? I followed.

We walked for maybe ten minutes, zigzagging through streets I'd never have figured out on my own. At one point, he stopped to buy a newspaper and handed me a chestnut as if

to say, *relax, you'll get there*. Finally, he pointed at a building—my hotel. I turned to thank him, but he was already walking back the way we came, like it was just another Tuesday for him. That's the thing about traveling somewhere new. You think not knowing the language is going to be a nightmare, but honestly? It's where the best stories come from. Like the time I tried to order tea and accidentally asked for *your grandmother*. Or when an old lady in a market decided I needed a scarf and just wrapped one around me, smiling like she'd made the best decision of my life. Or the time I got into a taxi, said the only phrase I knew, and somehow ended up at a wedding. I ate, I danced, and left with new friends—none of whom spoke my language. The words don't matter. People find ways to connect anyway. And those are the moments you never forget.

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भाषा, संकल्पना आणि संस्कृती



नवे विचार, नवे शब्द

काही नवीन आविष्करणांबरोबर, बदलत्या जीवन पद्धतीबरोबर, नवीन विचारांच्या, प्रणालींच्या शोधाबरोबर अनेक नवीन शब्द भाषेत येतात, तर काही जुने शब्द वापरात राहात नाहीत. दूरभाष, चलभाष, चांद्रयान, संगणक असे काही नवे शब्द मराठीत रुळले आहेत. फडताळ, सदरा, वळचण, पागोळी, कुंची, गुटी, परस असे किती तरी शब्द वापरात राहिलेले नाहीत. परसबागेचं 'किचन गार्डन'

झालं. काही शब्द नवीन फॅशनबरोबर वापरात येतात, तर काही शब्दच फॅशन म्हणून वापरात येतात, काही 'स्टेटस' दाखवणारे म्हणून प्रचलित असतात. इतर बोलींचा किंवा भाषांचा परिणाम होऊन एखाद्या भाषेत नवीन शब्द, नव्या रचना येतात. अशी अनेक मार्गांनी भाषा बदलत आणि वृद्धिंगत होत असते.

नव्या विषयांबरोबर किंवा नव्या विचारांबरोबर नवे शब्द निर्माण

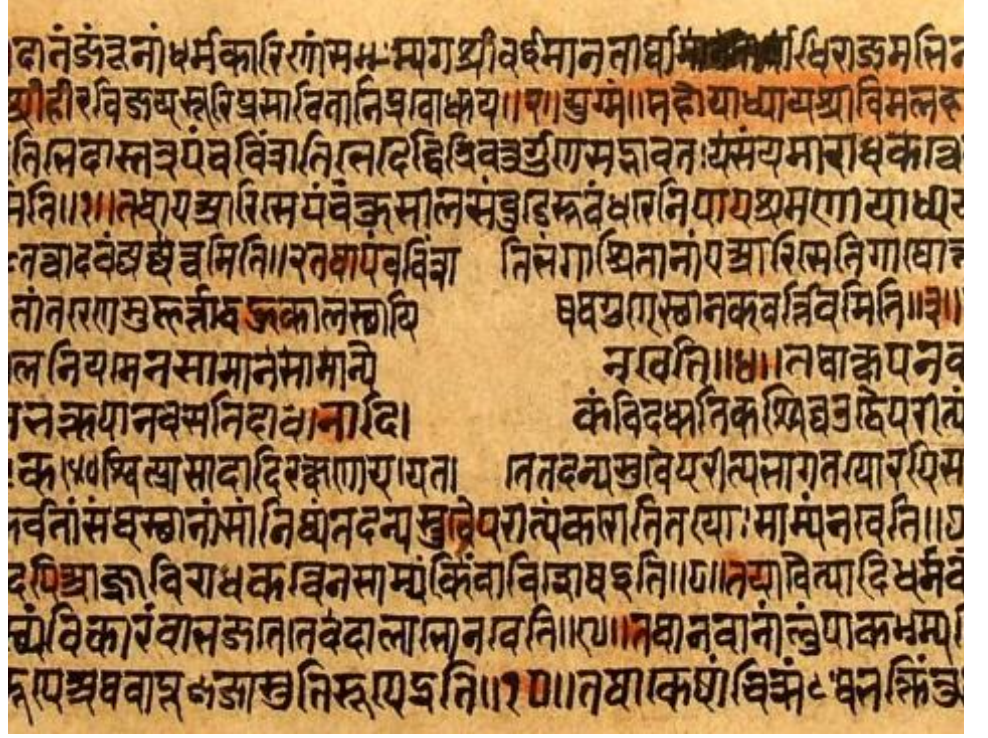
होतात, वापरात येतात. हे तर जिवंत भाषेचं लक्षणच आहे.

संगणकाबरोबर आलेले डाऊन लोड कर, ई-मेल लिही, गूगल करून बघ, असे शब्द; किंवा 'लाइफ स्टाइल' बदलल्याने आलेले शब्द. जसे जीन्स, टी-शर्ट, गॅस, बाथरूम, टॉयलेट, गीझर, बाईक, वन बेडरूम फ्लॅट, टॅक्सी असे अनेक शब्द मराठीने आपलेसे करून घेतले आहेत. 'काय टाईम झाला', हे प्रचलित आहे.

'किती वाजले' हे जास्त शुद्ध आणि प्रतिष्ठित वाटायला लागलं आहे!

'लई भारी' ग्रामीण मराठीतून, 'अरे वा! क्या बात है' हिंदीतून, 'बहुत खूब' उर्दूतून, 'व्हेरी गुड', 'परफेक्ट', 'सुपर्ब' असे इतर भाषांमधून घेतलेले अभिव्यक्तीचे नवे मार्ग सध्या आपल्याकडे प्रचलित आहेत, विशेषतः तरुण पिढीमधे. असे बदल हे भाषेत होतच राहातात, भाषेची व्याप्ती वाढतच राहते.

काळाप्रमाणे भाषा बदलत जाते, हे तर आपल्याला माहीतच आहे. ज्ञानेश्वर, शिवाजी, टिळक, सावरकर, कुरुंदकर, नेमाडे, महानोर, ढासळ, सुर्वे यांनी लिहिलेल्या मराठीत काळानुसार बदल झालेला आपण बघतो. पंडित कवींचं काव्य, मर्ढेकरांची कविता, लावण्या-पोवाडे हे सर्व वेगवेगळ्या धाटणीचं साहित्य मराठी भाषेतच आहे. फक्त आजच्या मराठीचा विचार केला, तर आपल्या भोवतीची अनेक माणसं आपापल्या धाटणीमध्ये मराठीचा वापर करताना दिसतात. तसं पाहायला गेलं तर बस कंडक्टर, रिश्का चालक, आपले मित्र, घरकामाची गडीमाणसं, आपले बाबा, आपली आजी हे सर्व जण



मराठीच बोलत असले तरी प्रत्येकाची भाषा काही प्रमाणात वेगळी असते, नाही का? आपण सगळे मराठी बोलत असलो तरी नागपूर, कोल्हापूर, वऱ्हाड, मराठवाडा इथे बोललं जाणारं मराठी वेगळं वेगळं असतं. ग्रामीण, कोकणी, आदिवासी पाड्यांवरचं मराठी वेगळं असतं. काळ, वय, शिक्षण, स्थान, पेशा इत्यादी घटकांनुसार भाषांचा वापर बदलत असतो. वेगळे शब्द, वेगळे उच्चार, आवाजातले वेगळे चढ-उतार, हेल, इत्यादी फरक असूनही ह्या सगळ्या अभिव्यक्तीच्या प्रकाराला मिळून आपण 'ही मराठी भाषा आहे' असंच म्हणतो. आपण सगळे वेगवेगळं बोलत असलो तरीही आपण एकच भाषा बोलत असतो - ती म्हणजे मराठी!

भाषेतल्या अमर्याद शक्यता आणि मर्यादा

प्रत्येक भाषेमध्ये अभिव्यक्तीच्या संभाव्य शक्यता अमर्याद आहेत, तरी भाषेला मर्यादा आहेत. सर्वसाधारण भाषेची व्याप्ती, भाषेचा आवाका आणि भाषेची सर्जन-क्षमता अमर्याद आहे, हे खरं आहे. तरी कोणत्याही एका भाषेत सगळं जग कधीच अभिव्यक्त होत नाही. प्रत्येक भाषा सभोतालचं जग आपल्या नजरेतून बघते आणि तेवढंच जग शब्दांकित करते. एकेका भाषेची ही मर्यादा आहे.

त्येक भाषेला अनेक प्रकारे मर्यादा पडतात. त्या त्या भाषेची, भाषासमाजाची, भाषा वापरणा-या व्यक्तीची, तिच्या

अनुभवाची मर्यादा भाषेला पडते. जो तो भाषासमाज आपल्या नजरेतून जग न्याहाळत असतो. त्या समाजाला जाणवलेल्या एका एका छोट्या तुकड्याला, एका वस्तूला, एका भावनेला, एका विचाराला, एका कल्पनेला तो भाषासमाज एक नाव देत असतो आणि त्याची विभागणी, त्याचं वर्गीकरण करत असतो.

नैसर्गिक संकल्पनांच्या क्षेत्रात संस्कृतिक संकल्पना घुसत राहातात. आपलं शरीर आणि अवयव निसर्गानं दिलेले आहेत. पण त्यांची विभागणी प्रत्येक भाषासमाज वेगवेगळ्या गटात करतो. ज्यू भाषासमाजात गळा आणि मान असे दोन शब्द आहेत, तर इंग्रजीमध्ये पुढचा भाग आणि मागचा भाग, दोन्हीला neck म्हणतात आणि throat म्हणजे फक्त तोंडाच्या आतला भाग. मराठीमध्ये आपण गळा, घसा आणि मान अशी स्पष्ट विभागणी करतो. हाताची विभागणी इंग्रजीत arm आणि hand अशी होते. तशी ती हिब्रूमध्ये होत नाही. मराठीमध्ये हाताची स्पष्ट विभागणी आहे आणि हात, दंड, पंजा असे वेगवेगळे शब्द आहेत. पण मराठीतही आपण 'हात' हा शब्द सर्वार्थानं वापरतो. प्रश्न विचारायचा असेल तर हात वर करा, असं आपण म्हणतो, 'खाऊसाठी हात पुढे कर' म्हणतो. 'स्वैपाक करतांना हात भाजला' म्हणतो, तेव्हा खूपदा तळवा किंवा बोटं अभिप्रेत असतात. 'हाताला इंजक्शन दिलं म्हणतो', तेव्हा दंड अभिप्रेत असतो.

हे शब्द आणि त्यांचा वापर संस्कृतिनिष्ठच राहातो. जसं ऋतू, आपण भारतात तीनच ऋतू मानतो. म्हणजे एका वर्षाची विभागणी तीन तुकड्यात करतो. आपल्याला उन्हाळा, हिवाळा, पावसाळा ही विभागणी पुरेशी वाटते.



पण काही भाषासमाज हवामानानुसार वर्षाचे spring, summer, autumn, winter असे चार भाग करतात. त्यांना 'पावसाळ' अशा स्वतंत्र ऋतूची गरज वाटत नाही, कारण त्याठिकाणी सगळ्या ऋतूत पाऊस पडतो. आता इंग्रजी आणि जर्मनमध्ये भात आणि तांदूळ दोन्हीला एकच शब्द आहे 'राइस'. ह्या उलट इंग्रजीत बर्फामध्ये 'स्नो' आणि 'आईस' असा फरक करतात. आपण मराठीत असा फरक करत नाही. दोन्हीला आपण बर्फ असंच म्हणतो - फ्रिजमधला बर्फ आणि पडणारा बर्फ. संस्कृतचा आधार घेत आपण कधी 'हिमवर्षाव' झाला, असंही म्हणतो. असं वाचनात आलं आहे, की, एस्किमो लोक तर १०-१२ वेगवेगळ्या प्रकारचे बर्फ 'ओळखतात' आणि ते शब्दांकित करतात, म्हणजे त्यांना वेगवेगळी नावं देतात. 'भाषेकडे बघताना...' मध्ये ओळख झालेला 'ग्रेन्युई' कसं लाकडाच्या वासात, दुधाच्या

चवीत फरक करायचा, त्याची आठवण होते. त्याचा थोडा सविस्तर संदर्भ पुढे आला आहे.

सभोवतीच्या जगाची विभागणी आणि त्यांचं नामकरण ह्या प्रत्येक भाषेच्या घडणीतल्या प्रक्रिया आहेत. त्यामुळे नैसर्गिक संकल्पना आणि गटवारी ब-याच प्रमाणात अनेक भाषांना सामाईक असली तरी सांस्कृतिक संकल्पना आणि जगाची विभागणी बरेचदा भिन्न असू शकते.

अशामुळे कित्येकदा आपल्याला आपल्या भाषेत एकदम चपखल शब्द आठवत नाही किंवा तसा शब्द आपल्या भाषेत नसतोच. मग त्यासाठी दुसऱ्या भाषेतला शब्द वापरला जातो आणि हे अनेक भाषांमध्ये होतच असतं. परभाषेतून इंग्रजीत आलेल्या अशा 'अँग्लो-इंडियन' शब्दांसाठी 'हॉब्सन जॉब्सन' असा एक आगळावेगळा शब्दकोशच आहे. त्यामध्ये

भारतीय आणि इतर आशियाई भाषांमधून घेतलेले खूप शब्द समाविष्ट केलेले आहेत. उदाहरणार्थ घाट, चपाती, योग, चारपोंय, चटणी इत्यादी.

आता वेगवेगळ्या क्षेत्रात वापरले जाणारे शब्द वेगळे असतात. न्याय, विधी किंवा कायद्याचं क्षेत्र, तंत्रज्ञान, सूक्ष्म जीवशास्त्र, अभियांत्रिकी, अंतराळ विज्ञान, वैद्यक ह्या क्षेत्रांमध्ये वापरले जाणारे शब्द खूपदा त्या क्षेत्रात वापरल्या जाणाऱ्या पारिभाषिक संज्ञा असतात. त्यासाठी मराठीमध्येही अनेक परिभाषाकोश निर्माण केले गेले आहेत. पण आपण त्यांचा तितकासा उपयोग करून घेत नाही. त्या ऐवजी आपण बरेचदा इंग्रजी शब्द वापरणंच 'prefer' करतो!!

म्हणजेच भाषेची क्षमता अमर्याद असली तरी प्रत्येक भाषेमध्ये निर्माण होणारे शब्द वेगवेगळे असतात, त्यांची संख्याही वेगळी आणि मर्यादित असते. अशा रीतीनं प्रत्येक भाषा सभोतालचं जग आपल्या नजरेतून बघते आणि तेवढंच जग शब्दांकित करते. भाषेला मर्यादा आहे, तशीच भाषेतल्या अभिव्यक्तीला, तिच्या वापराला वैयक्तिक मर्यादाही असते.

आता मराठीसारख्या भाषेचा शब्दसंग्रह खूपच मोठा असला आणि मराठीत असंख्य वाक्यं करता येत असली, तरी यातल्या काही मर्यादित शक्यतांचाच

प्रत्येक माणूस प्रत्यक्ष उपयोग करीत असतो. काही कवी आणि लेखकांना वाग्देवता आणि सरस्वती प्रसन्न असते. ग. दि. माडगुळकर, आरतीप्रभू, कुसुमाग्रज, टिळक, सावरकर ह्यांनी मराठीच्या व्यापक शब्दसंग्रहाचा, भाषेतल्या सौंदर्याचा आणि तिच्या क्षमतेचा जसा वापर केला, तसा अर्थातच प्रत्येक मराठी भाषकाला करता येणार नाही.



LANGUAGE, CONCEPTS, AND CULTURE



New Thoughts, New Words

With some new inventions, with changing lifestyles, and with the discovery of new ideas and systems, many new words come into the language, while some old words are no longer in use. Some new words like telephone, mobile phone, Chandrayaan, computer have become entrenched in Marathi. Many words like Phadtal, Sadra, Valchan, Pagoli, Kunchi, Gutti, and Paras are no longer in use. The backyard has become a 'kitchen garden.' Some words come into use with new fashion, while some words are used only as fashion, and some are popular as 'status' indicators. New words and new structures come into a language as a result of other dialects or languages. Language changes and grows in many ways.

With new topics or new ideas, new words are created and come into use. This is a sign of a living language.

Words like 'download,' 'write an e-mail,' and 'google it' that come with computers, or words that come with changing 'lifestyle.' Marathi has adopted many words like jeans, T-shirt, gas, bathroom, toilet, geyser, bike, one-bedroom flat, and taxi. 'What time is it?' is popular. 'What time is it?' has started to sound more refined and prestigious!

'Lai Bhari' from rural Marathi, 'Aare Wa! Kya Baat Hai' from Hindi, 'Baahu Khoob' from Urdu, 'Very Good', 'Perfect', and 'Superb' from other languages; new ways of expression are currently popular with us, especially

among the younger generation. Such changes keep happening in the language; the scope of the language keeps increasing.

We know that language changes with time. We see changes in Marathi written by Dnyaneshwar, Shivaji, Tilak, Savarkar, Kurundkar, Nemade, Mahanor, Dhasal, and Surve. The poetry of Pandit poets, the poetry of Mardhekars, and Lavanya-Powade—all these different styles of literature are in the Marathi language. If we just think about today's Marathi, we see many people around us using Marathi in their own style.

If we look at it like that, even though bus conductors, rickshaw drivers, our friends, housework workers, our fathers, and our grandmothers all speak Marathi, everyone's language is different to some extent, isn't it? Even though we all speak Marathi, the Marathi spoken here in Nagpur, Kolhapur, Varhad, and Marathwada is different. The Marathi spoken in rural, Konkani, tribal villages is different. The use of languages changes according to factors such as time, age, education, location, profession, etc. Despite the different words, different pronunciations, different inflections in the voice, etc., we still say that 'this is Marathi language' for all these forms of expression. Even though we all speak differently, we speak the same language—that is Marathi!

Unlimited possibilities and limitations of language

Although the potential possibilities of expression are unlimited in every language, language has its limitations. It is true that the scope of general language, the reach of language, and the creative capacity of language are unlimited. However, the entire world is never expressed in any one language. Every language sees the world around it from its own perspective and expresses that much of the world in words. This is the limitation of each language.

Every language has limitations in many ways. The limitations of that language, the language community, the person using the language, and their experience fall on the language. That

language community looks at the world through its own perspective. That language community gives a name to every small piece, an object, an emotion, a thought, and an idea that society perceives divides and classifies.

Cultural concepts keep entering the field of natural concepts. Our bodies and organs are given by nature. But each language community divides them into different groups. In the Jewish language community, there are two words, throat, and man, while in English, both the front and back parts are called neck, and throat means only the inside of the mouth. In Marathi, we make a clear distinction between throat, throat, and man. In English, the division of the hand is arm and hand. It is not the same in Hebrew. In



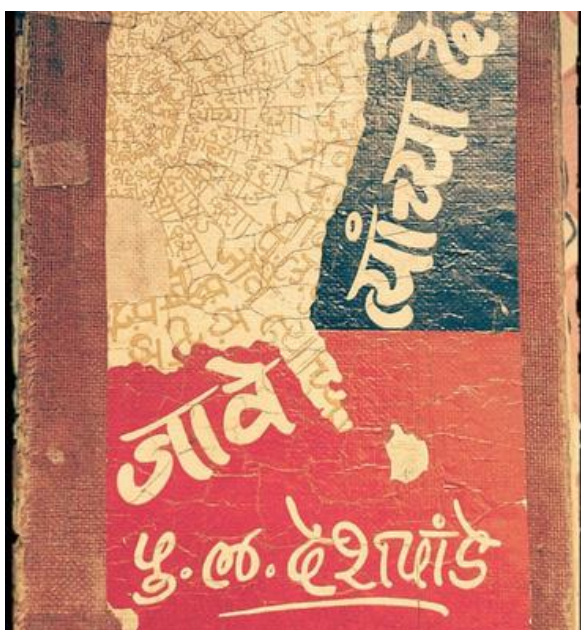
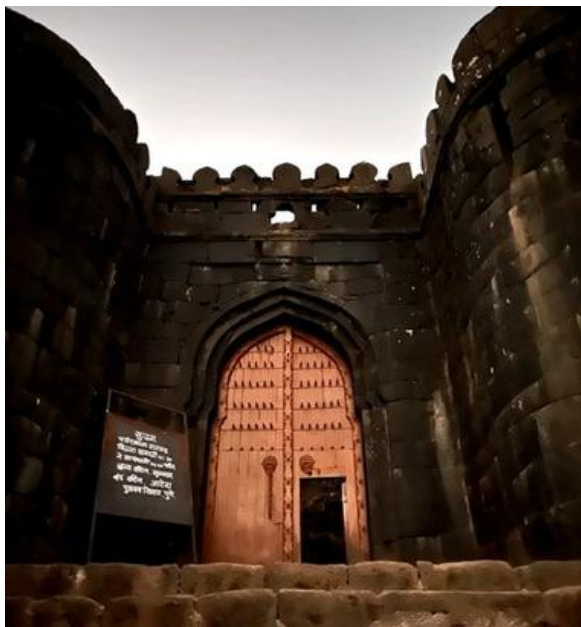


Marathi, there is a clear distinction between the hand, and there are different words like hand, stick, and claw. But in Marathi too, we use the word 'hand' in all its meanings. If we want to ask a question, we say, 'Raise your hand,' and we say, 'Put your hand forward for food.' When we say, 'I got a burn while cooking,' we often mean the palm or fingers. When we say, 'I gave an injection to my hand,' we mean the claw.

These words and their usage remain culturally specific. Like seasons. In India, we consider only three seasons. That is, we divide a year into three parts. We find the division of summer, winter, and monsoon sufficient. But some language communities divide the year into four parts: spring, summer, autumn, and winter, according to the weather. They do not feel the need for a separate season like 'rainy season' because it rains in all seasons there. Now in English and German, both rice and rice have the same word 'rice'. On the contrary, in English, they differentiate between 'snow' and 'ice.'. We do not make such a distinction in Marathi. We call both of them the same—the ice in the fridge and the falling ice. Taking Sanskrit as a basis, we also say when there has been a 'snowstorm'. It has been read that the Eskimos 'recognise' 10-12 different types of ice and verbalise them, that is, give them different names. It reminds me of how 'grainui,' introduced in 'Bhashekete Bektana...', distinguishes between the smell of wood and the taste of milk. A little detailed reference to it has been given.

The division of the world around us and their naming are processes in the formation of every language. Therefore, although natural concepts and groupings are common to many languages, cultural concepts and the division of the world can often be different.

Therefore, sometimes we do not remember a very clever word in our language, or such a word does not exist in our language. Then a word from another language is used for it, and this happens in many languages. There is a separate dictionary called 'Hobson Jobson' for such 'Anglo-Indian' words that have come to English from foreign languages.



It includes many words taken from Indian and other Asian languages. For example, ghat, chapati, yoga, charpoy, chutney, etc.

Now the words used in different fields are different. The words used in the fields of justice or law, technology, microbiology, engineering, space science, and medicine are often terminology used in those fields. For this, many dictionaries have been created in Marathi as well. But we do not use them as much. Instead, we often prefer to use English words!!

That is, although the capacity of language is unlimited, the words produced in each language are different; their number is also different and limited.

In this way, each language sees the world around it through its own eyes and expresses the world in words. Language has its limits, just as there are personal limits to the expression of the language and its use.

Now, although the vocabulary of a language like Marathi is very large and countless sentences can be made in Marathi, every person actually uses only some of its limited possibilities. Some poets and writers are pleased with the goddess of speech and Saraswati. C. D. Madgulkar, Aartiprabhu, Kusumagraj, Tilak, and Savarkar, of course, cannot use the extensive vocabulary of Marathi, the beauty of the language, and its potential in the same way.



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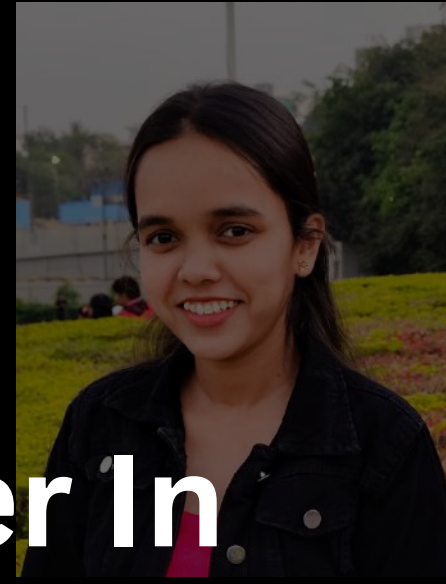
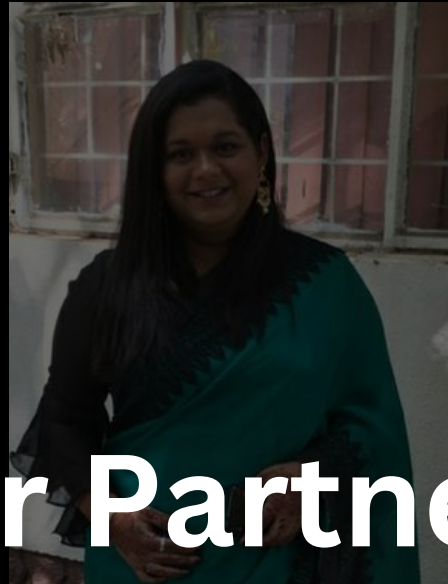
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